

COVID-19 Impact

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Q: What are the main lessons learnt under this programme from COVID-19 pandemic?

DESA is requested to provide the response based on the verbal responses from Mr. Harris

The COVID-19 pandemic had demonstrated the value of the Regular Programme of Technical Cooperation, providing the framework and funding to respond immediately to requests for assistance from Member States.

COVID-19 has changed the way the United Nations as well as Governments operate profoundly. As no other alternative was available, we were forced to switch to virtual means of delivery. While many colleagues in the implementing entities had already worked on e-Learning courses, the pandemic helped making our government counterparts also more receptive to participating in virtual meetings and e-learning courses. The implementing entities have been able to adapt to the new modality and has proven that in many areas it works even better than requiring physical participation. In fact, many Inter-Regional Advisors (IRA) report a significant increase in demand for advisory services, given the new global acceptance and use of virtual consultations, advisory services and peer reviews. Rather than waiting to embark on a physical mission, IRAs have been able to cater to a high volume of requests for advisory services, supporting different time zones and more meetings as previously experienced due to a renewed sense of “around the clock availability” and responsiveness.

E-learning courses were able to reach a higher number of participants in beneficiary countries as we would be able to reach in a classroom setting. It allows participants to learn in their own time and schedule. Last not least, reduced costs for travel allows us to achieve more with the money we have, thus allows investing the savings in enhancing our advisory capacity and virtual trainings.

However, e-learning and virtual workshops are not suited for every setting. Sometimes, direction setting discussions with high-level government officials can be more effective in person as well as some hands-on technical trainings yield better results than trying to build highly technical skills through e-learning or other virtual means.

Moving forward, we see the importance of understanding and leveraging the advantages and disadvantages of in-person versus virtual advisory services and training, and the previously untapped potential of hybrid engagements and advisory services. RPTC support can then be truly:

sustainable

both high- and low-tech

Scaled

co-created in close collaboration with government counterparts, and

Leverage on the available expertise in the country in the UNCT and RCO

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Q: To what extent was the RPTC programme able to continue its training to address identified capacity gaps during the COVID-19 pandemic travel restrictions (para. 23.20 and 23.21)?

DESA is requested to provide the response based on the verbal responses from Mr. Harris. Under the COVID-19 related travel restrictions, RPTC entities was able to quickly adapt to the new environment and continued to provide advisory services through remote support, except for some activities that were not easy to undertake online such as: inter-ministerial discussions; stakeholder workshops and consultations with a wide variety of national stakeholders. Online consultations and virtual workshops cannot fully take the place of in-person meetings. Often in-person consultations are the only way to reach those left furthest behind that are not empowered to connect virtually, and might have difficulties in using digital technologies, are living in rural or remote areas and without easy access to WIFI/data and equipment that would be needed to work virtually, which is often expensive for them.

Other challenges were the significant investment of time and resources to convert materials developed for face-to-face training into a format that allows for remote delivery, as well as investment in licenses for suitable platforms and tools that can be used for virtual workshops and training. Training and preparing the human resources (staff members including advisors) for virtual deliveries instead of in-person have been in progress. This will require both mobilization of additional resources and flexibility to adjust existing cost-plans. It will be important to support developing countries in upgrading their technology to ensure access to online capacity development tools and activities.

The COVID-19 pandemic and related travel restrictions demanded quick action to transform Implementing Entities' in-person activities into virtual ones, enabling continuous support while calibrating its offering in view of new urgent requests for assistance.

While Implementing Entities already has experience delivering its capacity development activities (trainings, workshops, webinars, policy advice) through electronic means, email, voice and video calls, virtual meetings and virtual training courses and toolkits, the COVID-19 pandemic requires the Implementing Entities to accelerate these efforts. Many of the Implementing Entities are currently rolling out facilitator training for virtual meetings and events to quickly increase our staff's acquisition of the latest skills, methods and techniques using a variety of platforms. We will closely monitor the feedback and success of all virtual activities, by assessing and evaluating learning outcomes and client feedback as well as by comparing costs/savings vis-à-vis in-person capacity development support. Based on the new data points generated, we will critically review whether, how and when it would be effective in the future to replace in-person activities with virtual ones. This assessment would have to take into consideration the reported challenges relating to connectivity limitations, bandwidth as well as accessibility considerations and the need for multi-language servicing and simultaneous interpretation.

Ultimately, the goal is to offer the best suited assistance to Member States while incurring the least possible costs, and thus building a capacity development delivery strategy that is sustainable and effective in meeting our client's demands.

Q: In the context of the impact of the COVID-19 pandemic, please advise how many of the implementing entities switched to virtual arrangements for 2020 and 2021.

All entities are requested to advise on whether they implemented virtual arrangements for 2020 and 2021

DESA: DESA switched to virtual arrangements for both 2020 and 2021.

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Q: In the context of the increase proposed for consultants, please provide an explanation for the proposed increase.

The following entities are requested to provide an expanded explanation for the increase proposed under consultants. Please expand on the information already supplied in the variance analysis in the fascicle which should be in accordance with the information provided in the response for question 34. Please also make reference to linages to hybrid or online support in line with the request in question 44.

DESA (\$155,800) to assist DESA to design and implement new delivery modalities using information technologies and e-learning, blended with traditional training modalities, to help realize the transformative change that the RPTC interventions set out to achieve. This applies to capacity development activities as well as the delivery of high-level meetings and consultations which benefit from virtual technology to achieve its objectives.

UN-Habitat (\$110,800) to provide additional technical expertise in new focus areas highlighted in the Strategic Plan 2020 – 2023 and technical advisory services in regions and countries where UN-Habitat does not have either regional or country presence

UNODC (\$32,500) to provide additional resources to implementing partners, to enlarge the scope of the support actions by covering more beneficiary countries, as well as to provide additional specialized expertise on ground.

OHCHR (\$157,700) to provide increased engagement with Peer Support Groups (PSG) in the Africa and MENA regions under the Regional Collaborative Platform (RCP) and additional technical support for meetings that will now take place virtually

ECA (\$238,400) to provide additional advisory services and capacity-building tailored to specific country needs along the five thematic areas: (a) macroeconomic policy and governance and economic development and planning; (b) regional integration and trade and private sector development and finance; (c) data and statistics; (d) climate change, environment and natural resources management;

and (e) gender equality and women's empowerment and poverty inequality and social policy geared towards to assist Member States in their recovery from the COVID-19 pandemic.

ESCAP (\$1,137,400) to provide resources to address cross-cutting issues and emerging priority areas in Asia and the-Pacific, such as (a) support to countries with special needs; (b) support to the implementation, follow-up and review of the 2030 Agenda, including through preparation and follow-up of Voluntary National Reviews; and (c) support to alignment of national development plans and sustainable development cooperation frameworks with regional, subregional and transboundary priorities of the member States, including COVID-19 response and recovery.

ECE (\$328,700) to provide demand driven capacity building services including additional field projects.

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Q: Please provide more detailed information on the increased requirements for capacity building that are related to the proposed increases in the resource requirements.

All entities, please provide additional information on any planned increases in capacity building activities and any related increase in the proposed resources

DESA: The proposed regular budget resources for 2022 amount to \$8,945,900 and reflect a resource increase of \$581,500, or 7.0 per cent, compared with the appropriation for 2021. The proposed increase under other staff costs (\$619,700) is to strengthen DESA's staff capacity to meet the demands of Member States in the context of COVID-19 recovery. In response to the anticipated increased requests in 2022, DESA will provide advisory services and capacity-development support at the national level in developing countries to design and implement sustainable development strategies and policy responses for COVID-19 recovery efforts, the proposed increase under consultants (\$155,800) is to assist DESA to design and implement new delivery modalities using information technologies and e-learning, blended with traditional training modalities, to help realize the transformative change that the RPTC interventions set out to achieve. This applies to capacity development activities as well as the delivery of high-level meetings and consultations which benefit from virtual technology to achieve its objectives, partially offset by a proposed decrease under travel of staff (\$220,000) reflecting the continued practice of virtual interactions to support the recovery instead of in person travel in 2022.

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(OLD TEXT) DESA (\$155,800) to assist DESA to design and implement new delivery modalities using information technologies and e-learning, blended with traditional training modalities, to help realize the transformative change that the RPTC interventions set out to achieve. This applies to capacity development activities as well as the delivery of high-level meetings and consultations which benefit from virtual technology to achieve its objectives.

(NEW TEXT) DESA (\$155,800) Since the onset of the pandemic and the cessation travel and in-person activities, DESA worked diligently to ensure uninterrupted support to Member States' urgent needs, especially, due to the socio and economic impact of the pandemic, and successfully designed and implemented new delivery modalities using information technologies and e-learning, blended with traditional training modalities, to help realize the transformative change that the RPTC interventions set out to achieve. This meant that virtual means of delivery needed to be complemented by national and regional consultants that responded to specific country requests by providing technical expertise which is not available in-house as well as maximise the impact of country level work by organizing follow-up actions to support the work of the advisors.

UN-Habitat (\$110,800) to provide additional technical expertise in new focus areas highlighted in the Strategic Plan 2020 – 2023 and technical advisory services in regions and countries where UN-Habitat does not have either regional or country presence

UNODC (\$32,500) to provide additional resources to implementing partners, to enlarge the scope of the support actions by covering more beneficiary countries, as well as to provide additional specialized expertise on ground.

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ECA (\$238,400) to provide additional advisory services and capacity-building tailored to specific country needs along the five thematic areas: (a) macroeconomic policy and governance and economic development and planning; (b) regional integration and trade and private sector development and finance; (c) data and statistics; (d) climate change, environment and natural resources management; and (e) gender equality and women's empowerment and poverty inequality and social policy geared towards to assist Member States in their recovery from the COVID-19 pandemic.

ESCAP (\$1,137,400) to provide resources to address cross-cutting issues and emerging priority areas in Asia and the-Pacific, such as (a) support to countries with special needs; (b) support to the implementation, follow-up and review of the 2030 Agenda, including through preparation and follow-up

of Voluntary National Reviews; and (c) support to alignment of national development plans and sustainable development cooperation frameworks with regional, subregional and transboundary priorities of the member States, including COVID-19 response and recovery.

ECE (\$328,700) to provide demand driven capacity building services including additional field projects.

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Q: Please provide details of the increase of \$261,100 under grants and contributions. Please further justify the increased requirements under grants and contributions being significantly higher than actuals in 2022. Please provide an answer, by entity (DESA, OHCHR, ECA, ECE, ECLAC, ESCWA) on the main activities to be financed by grants and contributions and justifications on the differences between actuals and proposals for 2024.

DESA

4.1 The proposed increase in resources proposed for 2024 reflects the inclusion of additional resources to undertake capacity-building workshops in DESA's priority areas of SIDS, Africa and LDC and LLDC to increase the capacity of Member States to formulate reports on national progress towards the achievement of the 2030 Agenda.

OHCHR

4.2 OHCHR is expecting to use the amount allotted under grants and contributions to continue financing its two existing comprehensive fellowship programmes under Sub-programme 1 and Subprogramme 3. Further information on the use of the fellowship programmes can be found in the response for question 28 in this set. In response to the anticipated requests in 2024, as stated in the proposed programme budget for 2024 under section 23, OHCHR also expects to:

- a) broaden the scope of the two fellowship programmes to include deployment of former indigenous fellows and minority fellows as "Senior Fellows" to receive on the job training to OHCHR country or regional offices, UNCTs, or UN Peacekeeping Missions;
- b) further develop and refine methodology and guidance material on the two fellowship programmes to facilitate an increased number of fellows' participation in the programmes virtually and strengthen capacities to ensure the monitoring of human rights situations through online tools, and;
- c) implement further capacity-building activities for indigenous, minorities and NHRI fellows to constructively engage in UN meetings, UN human rights mechanisms and implementation of the SDGs in the context of the response to the COVID-19 pandemic.

4.3 OHCHR will also make use of these funds to support the travel of participants to the different activities planned for 2024.

ECA

4.4 The proposed increase of \$257,500 under grants and contributions for ECA would provide for activities related to the building of capacity of economic, planning, statistical and social development policies and frameworks.

4.5 In response to an anticipated increase in the volume of requests for assistance from member

States, ECA would provide additional support on (i) training of national policy makers in assessing poverty, vulnerability and inequality and generating estimates that would support the identification of effective policy options that address risks and build economic resilience; (ii) strengthening the capacity of countries' National Statistical Officials to advance national statistics data; and (iii) improving capacity of selected countries in strengthening financing frameworks within national development planning processes.

4.6 These activities would be supported by providing training, conducting workshops for the stakeholders, provision of technical support, and advisory services by staff, technical experts and consultants.

ECE

4.7 There is no proposed increase for grants and contributions in ECE for 2024 as compared with appropriation for 2023. The planned allocation for grants and contributions for 2024 will be used for capacity building training and workshops based on the demand of the member States and in line with the ECE's mandates. The difference between actual 2022 expenditures and the 2024 proposal reflects both the growing demand for capacity building activities in ECE programme countries and the increased travel by participants of those activities as a result of lifting the COVID-19 related restrictions.

ECLAC

4.8 There is no proposed increase for grants and contributions in ECLAC for 2024 as compared with appropriation for 2023. ECLAC resources under grants and contributions budget line are to cover for the travel of meeting participants. Expenditures under this item in 2022 still reflected the COVID-19 mitigation measures related restrictions put in place in many countries of the region and closure of borders due to the pandemic. This trend started to change in the second semester of the 2022 as restrictions started to ease and travel resumed in most of the countries (albeit with less availability of routes and flights) allowing for seminars, workshops and trainings to be delivered through face-to-face modalities.

ESCWA

4.9 ESCWA is receiving an increasing number of member States' requests year-on-year: from 120 in 2020, the number reached 148 in 2021, 169 in 2022, and 100 by June 2023. These increasing numbers of requests entail more capacity development interventions and additional advisory services using ESCWA policy tools that require training. These increasing numbers of requests also entail national consultation workshops for final agreements on policy documents produced through RPTC. Part of the expenses incurred during these trainings and workshops is funded through the grants and contributions budget line of the RPTC.

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Q: There is the issue of why consultants are being hired that causes a lot of questions to be raised– for example:

- UN-Habitat hired 3 national consultants for 2 days to “Review of the 2018-2021 Habitat Country Programme Documents for Africa region”. The rationale given was “Unique professional expertise in

the review of HCPD” – very vague

- An international consultant was hired to make a “Presentation at the National Urban Forum”, the rationale given was “Unique professional expertise in the subject matter presented at the Forum” – very vague

6.1 Based on the member State’s request, an international consultant working for UN-Habitat’s Data Analytics Unit was cost shared to technically support the evidence-based urban policy development in Azerbaijan. While the Data Analytics Unit covered the consultancy fee, RTPC covered the travel budget. The main objective of the mission was the exchange with the State Committee for Urban Planning and Architecture in Azerbaijan as well as the Statistical Committee on the localization of the Global Urban Monitoring Framework (UMF) in the country, as part of the Harmonized Global UN Systemwide Strategy for monitoring the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) and New Urban Agenda (NUA) and other regional, national, and subnational urban programmes. The mission was planned alongside the first National Urban Forum in Azerbaijan (NUFA1) in 2022 (<https://nufa.az/>) which brought together key urban professionals to discuss sustainable urbanization and housing issues as well as allowed to conduct an initial assessment on the set of urban indicators applied to the Azerbaijan context and capacity assessment of national and local institutions to utilize the UMF to ensure thematic integration and interlinkages among various dimensions of development, disaggregation of data, and inclusion of groups that are traditionally excluded. The programmatic content of and follow-up to NUFA1 was technically supported by RTPC.

- DESA hired an international consultant for 130 days to “Support divisions in e-learning; help scale e-learning support and evaluate support”. The rationale given was “New function that requires support in order to meet the demand of divisions in this area”

6.2 The RTPC supports small-scale interventions in response to member States’ requests for assistance. Since demand has been higher than the ability to respond, DESA started strategically exploring how digital capacity development support could increase the impact of its in-person capacity development support. This was started when travel was restricted in response to COVID-19 and digital support remained a vital tool to keep engagement with Member States. Responses were very positive, and DESA hired a consultant to help increase the availability of its free courses and cohort-based support on a Learning Management System (LMS), which has been provided by the UN System Staff College (UNSSC). DESA plans to continue to focus on hybrid support, balancing in-person and virtual support, in order to increase its reach and the depth of its support to Member States. Since DESA did not previously have any central digital in-house expertise, consultants have been essential in filling that gap. To date, over 2000 participants have been registered and explored its e-learning offering which can be accessed through its public website.

- ECA hired 15 international consultants for 675 days for the “Development of Models for Supporting Average of 10% Economic Growth in Africa” The rationale given was “Selected Young Junior macroeconomic modelers to participate in a team of researchers that will develop two sets of models of Macroeconomic Models that will support policies in African countries to generate 10% economic growth per annum. Under the leadership of the senior macroeconomic modelers, the YEN junior modelers participated in the following: (i) Literature Search; (ii) Data collection; (iii) Developing Structure of the Models; (iv) Selection of Scenarios implemented for the models; (v) development of Interim Report” Were the consultants from the African region or elsewhere? Did the junior modelers get paid? Were they paid fairly?

6.3 The consultants were from the African region. Included in the total of 15 are 10 junior modelers who assisted the senior consultants in research activities implemented under the ECA Young Economic

Network (ECA-YEN) with the development of Macroeconomic Models that guide policies in African countries to generate 10% economic growth per annum. The collaborative research aimed to develop two models: (i) A generic macro econometric model, and (ii) a dynamic computable general equilibrium model. In the course of implementing the project, the selected ten YEN Junior Modelers were paid a stipend of US\$2,000 for their participation in the following activities:

a) Literature Search: The Junior Modelers were assigned several literatures to read and to summaries, as inputs to the sections on background to the project and literature review.

b) Data collection: The two models required extensive and intensive data. The Junior Modelers participated in data collection and processing.

c) Developing Structure of the Models: The Junior modelers participated in the meetings leading to agreement on the structure of the models, levels of disaggregation of countries and sectors used in the model and the final report.

The above are examples of the vague language used to justify some of the consultancies, suggesting the need for better oversight of the entire programme. Please provide in writing the explanation given during the hearing as to how there will be better oversight and evaluation of RPTC in the future.

6.4 The consultants are evaluated based on their deliverables, and deliverables are formulated based on the expressed needs and gaps of member States. Each consultancy is evaluated against these deliverables in the standard Human Resources (HR) evaluation template.

6.5 There is no oversight of the consultants at the entire programme level. It is the responsibility of each implementing entity to evaluate its consultants, and the use of consultants in general.

Category: COVID-19 Impact | Source: PPB2024_ACABQ_QA_Section_23_RPTC_Set_2_final_26July2023.docx | Year: 2024

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Q: Please indicate the role played by RPTC staff in the execution of RPTC projects. How many staff participate in the execution of the projects in the field? Please provide concrete examples (noting the role played by consultants)

Information on the role of RPTC staff can be found in the individual entities sections below:

DESA

As of May 2023, DESA has 21 Inter-Regional Advisors (IRAs) who are funded by the RPTC. All IRAs, as integral part of their role, support Member States with capacity development and advisory support by transforming global policies and decisions into relevant national action. In addition to its IRAs, DESA uses other experts and staff to programme RPTC activities and advise Member States. Therefore, RPTC support is provided by a large number of experts, of which many are paid outside the RPTC, thus increasing the support under RPTC by adding other funding sources. All RPTC activities are implemented in response to direct requests from Member States. It is worth noting that many RPTC activities may lead to longer term “projects” funded by the Development Account or extra budgetary resources.

UNCTAD

In the case of UNCTAD, and the complementary nature of RPTC funding, the implementation of RPTC funded and co-funded activities is done by RPTC-funded staff as well as by RB and XB-funded staff.

For example, for the courses on key issues on the international economic agenda, delivered both in Geneva and in the field, the activity itself is funded by RPTC, but the staff implementing it, including the coordinator, are funded by regular budget. This is due to the fact that these courses are cross-divisional in their deliberations and implementation, and implementation is done in collaboration with staff members possessing the expertise in the various UNCTAD areas of work which come in for the specific day of the course to deliver a specific session. The main team coordinating the organization of these activities consists of three RB-funded staff members. As the focal point within the United Nations system for the integrated treatment of trade and development and interrelated issues in the areas of finance, technology, investment, and sustainable development (see paragraph 12 of the Nairobi Maafikiano), UNCTAD addresses these issues in a mutually complementary fashion. In the case of capacity-building programme on Rules of Origin for LDCs, that is carrying out applied research, developing tools, and capacity-building activities to assist LDC delegates in better participating and leading the work of the Committee on Rules of Origin, the activities in the field are delivered by the inter-regional advisor and two other staff members funded and co-funded by RPTC. In the case of eTrade readiness assessments, which help developing countries identify opportunities, barriers and policy solutions to drive digital transformation and e-commerce, the activities of the eCommerce programme are implemented by over 30 staff members, two of which are funded by RPTC.

UN-Habitat

The IRAs of UN-Habitat have been playing a catalytic role in establishing three of UN-Habitat's four flagship initiatives focusing on (1) Inclusive Communities, Thriving Cities; (2) People-centered Smart Cities; and (3) Sustainable Development Goals Cities. The first two initiatives were handed over to project teams and allowed for the active inter-regional work in Eastern Europe, South Caucasus and Central Asian regions where the focus is on establishing UN-Habitat sub-regional presence. In addition to establishing country programmatic approaches in Azerbaijan and Serbia, for example, technical support was provided to the urban recovery support in Ukraine.

UNODC

The RPTC funds supported the first international conference on prison management held by UNODC in Kyiv, Ukraine, with the participation of representatives from 18 UN member States as well as international organizations to discuss the unprecedented challenges facing Ukraine's prison and probation services. The event was organized by the Ministry of Justice and supported by UNODC through its RPTC inter-regional adviser; a prison reform adviser, and international and local staff based in the UNODC Programme Office in Ukraine.

OHCHR

When providing technical assistance to Member States and other stakeholders to advance the promotion and protection of the effective enjoyment by all of all human rights, OHCHR's RPTC staff can:

Provide human rights legal advice, education, awareness-raising and training through mutually agreed advisory services and technical cooperation programmes, including in the implementation of the recommendations to which States have agreed in the UPR process;

Provide technical assistance to Member States and key national actors, including National Human Rights Institutes (NHRIs), to promote the adoption of laws, policies and jurisprudence based on regional and international human rights standards on migration, recommendations of international human rights mechanisms

Conduct regional trainings and other capacity building activities

Act as team leaders during advisory and monitoring missions to the field

Facilitate spaces of dialogue between key government authorities, Civil Society Organizations (CSOs), NHRIs, associations and groups of migrants, regional networks of organizations

Provide technical assistance to national mechanisms to strengthen their capacity to monitor, document and report cases of human rights violations, to provide redress and accountability for victims of human rights violations, including for economic and social rights

Lead cooperation within the United Nations system for the integration of all human rights into United Nations programmes and activities in the development, environmental, humanitarian, peace and security, governance, democracy and rule of law areas, including the implementation of the 2030 Agenda;

Promote the practical integration of all human rights into development programmes, ensuring consistency and mutual reinforcement between United Nations-supported development activities and country engagement strategies that are jointly agreed upon with the Member States;

Contribute to developing the capability and knowledge of the United Nations system, regarding relevant human rights issues through training and advice, taking into account disability and mainstreaming a gender perspective;

Develop methodological tools to facilitate the practical integration of all human rights into United Nations policies, programmes and activities and, where appropriate, the advancement of the practical application of approaches to that end.

Example: Supporting the investigation of the Ayotzinapa case

The Interdisciplinary Group of Experts, set up by the Inter-American Commission of Human Rights to oversee the investigation and to report their findings both to the families and to the Mexican State, included an OHCHR RPTC-funded international consultant. The Group of Experts carried out briefings to authorities on national human rights standards and provided in-person and online technical assistance to the Special Prosecutor, his team and other authorities about judicial independence, applicable law, criminal justice system for the investigations, as well as on international human rights standards on torture and enforced disappearances.

Impacts of OHCHR Mexico assistance delivered through RPTC included:

Strengthened capacities of federal authorities to investigate and prosecute grave human rights violations, according to international human rights standards;

Strengthened NGOs' advocacy skills in cases of grave human rights violations;

Openness from the Ministry of Interior and the Special Prosecutor to collaborate with OHCHR in the investigation and the search for the disappeared students.

OCHA

Examples of the OCHA subprogramme's RPTC staff support include:

Subprogramme 2 - The humanitarian affairs officers play a key role in organizing and facilitating the events that raise awareness and foster collaboration, contributing to member states' access to international assistance (including the knowledge base and know-how) and improving their overall humanitarian preparedness and response capabilities. The number of staff involved in projects planning and implementation varies, however typically includes inter-sector and intra-sector coordination, emergency response and humanitarian information management specialists. Examples of their work can be seen in the results of collaboration with organizations like ASEAN and their participation in coordination mechanisms and emergency response simulation exercises in

disaster-prone regions such as Central America, alongside partners like PAHO.

Subprogramme 5 - The Associate Information System Officer role was critical in supporting the response for Ukraine as well as implementing the network and connectivity solution in the temporary OCHA office. In Haiti, a project was undertaken by OCHA to provide multi-agency hosting to UNHCR and the Resident's Coordinators Office (RCO). This connection provided each office with an unhindered access to the internet to hold high level planning meetings in support to humanitarian operations. The same approach was applied to support the following locations:

Chad: Ndjamenat: for RCO and OHCHR

Turkey: Gaziantep: for Deputy Regional Humanitarian Office, Surge Earthquake Feb 2023

Nigeria: Maiduguri: for UNWOMEN, CCCM, IMAP, UNMAS and Early Recovery

Myanmar: Sittwe: for RCO

OpT: Jerusalem: for Access Coordination Unit

Mozambique: Pemba: for OHCHR, UNDSS – contractual services from UNDP were used.

Niger: Niamey: for UNESCO

ECA

The RPTC staff of ECA engage with member States upon receipt of their requests and coordinate the implementation of the RPTC projects. Typically, implementation of one RPTC project involves discussions with member States, preparation of concept notes, research and analysis both remote and in country, organization and servicing of expert group meetings and workshops and recruiting and managing consultants and are performed by the regional advisor, two to three technical staff, one admin staff, one communications officer and supplemented by the engagement of one or two consultants.

For example, for the RPTC Project on "E-Mobility" (New Project), five ECA Staff Members will be involved in the project, the HQ Regional Advisor, two staff from Sub-Regional Office (SRO)-North Africa, one from SRO-Southern Africa and one from SRO-Central Africa. The Regional Advisor will lead the project, overseeing AfCFTA activities and technical work, outreach, and the project's successful implementation; while one SRO-North Africa staff will work on data collection and the other secretarial/admin support staff on various administrative tasks, ensuring smooth coordination within the project team and efficient communication with external stakeholders. Focal points from SRO-Central Africa and SRO-Southern Africa will be collaboratively involved in the project. Two consultants will be hired to conduct the analytical study and prepare technical briefs. Their expertise will contribute to the project's in-depth analysis and provide valuable insights.

ESCAP

ESCAP has 5 Regional Advisors and has benefited from the services of consultants (and individual contractors) as well as other staff to contribute to the delivery of RPTC interventions/projects, as outlined in detail in the supplementary information for ESCAP, table S.23.2.

The following describes how the various Regional Advisors (RA) have worked in delivery of RPTC-funded support to member States:

RA Pacific:

- Upon onboarding in March 2022, introduction and meeting with Governments (relevant/ministries and agencies) to socialize ESCAP's offer of support at national level
- Follow up on ongoing technical assistance and requests, including capacity building support, related but not limited to climate change mitigation and adaptation, disaster risk reduction, sustainable and

climate finance, and COVID-19 recovery

- Engage with UN agencies and partners to discuss potential cooperation to advance ESCAP work across Micronesia.

RA Green Financing:

- Deliver training on Sustainable Thematic Bond Issuance and Meetings with Government of Cambodia
- Deliver Financing Bhutan's Green Transition Workshop and meet with Government counterparts
- Deliver a two-day training on Sustainable Thematic Bond Issuance and Co-host a national workshop on Securing Inclusive and Green Economic Recovery and Development in Sri Lanka and Bilateral Meetings with Government.

RA Official Statistics (various countries):

- To work with the national statistical office on the improvement of statistical business processes; the development of training materials on official statistics and a related e-learning platform; and the planning of a review of the national statistical system
- To present on a variety of statistics-related topics (learning opportunities; the global SDG indicators database; national versus global SDG data; data disaggregation; use of big data in official statistics; dissemination of survey microdata; statistical disclosure control) for representatives of entities comprising the federal and provincial statistical systems with a view to identify priorities for related joint UN support
- To develop an indicator framework for the national policy for disaster management; and to identify priorities for joint UN support to statistics development
- To develop the sections on SDG progress and the national data ecosystem in the country's SDG Roadmap (continuation of work started in 2021)
- To support work towards outcome 1, Enhanced access to and use of reliable and timely data for inclusive and evidence-based policy and decision making, in the Cooperation Framework, and its evaluation
- To identify priorities for joint UN support to statistics development
- To work with the national statistical office on developing an indicator inventory
- To support the design of a Joint SDG Fund project on high-frequency monitoring of economic data
- To contribute to elements related to data and statistics in the Cooperation Framework.

RA Environment Statistics:

- To support Nepal Central Bureau of Statistics (CBS) with questionnaire and sampling design of Nepal's second Climate Change Impact Survey.
- To conduct a stakeholder workshop with stakeholders in Samoa to discuss the scope and continuation of Ocean Account in the country as well as to start collecting information on possible data sources for ecosystem accounts, understand priorities for the accounts and meet with stakeholders.

RA ASEAN:

- Facilitated the outreach of the Guidelines for Transformational Partnerships and Women's Economic Empowerment in Agriculture Value Chains within the ASEAN Secretariat (Poverty Eradication and Gender Division, and Food, Agriculture and Forestry Division) and moderated the special session with Indonesian Ministries (BAPPENAS, Ministry of Agriculture, Ministry of Cooperatives and SMEs, Ministry of Trade, and Ministry of Women Empowerment) together with the partner - Institute for Social Entrepreneurship in Asia (ISEA)
- A scoping mission on socio-economic impact of mines, site visit to an active mine field and rehabilitation center in Battambang Province was also conducted in consultation with UNDP and UNRCO

- Consultations with the ASEAN Secretariat Finance Integration Division and the ASEAN Senior Level on Financial Integration on possible ESCAP support in the development of an ASEAN Green Map - Sustainable Finance Roadmap
- Consultation on potential collaborations and support to the ASEAN Centre for Sustainable Development Studies and Dialogue.

ECE

Small scale demand driven field projects are executed either by ECE Regional Advisors (ECE has 6 RAs starting from 2022) or other staff if applicable. RPTC staff act as substantive project managers for the field projects and are fully responsible for successful project delivery. International consultants, usually from the region, are hired if specific expertise is needed in addition to the knowledge and expertise available at the secretariat. National consultants are hired for country-focused assignments. Deliverables such as studies, assessments etc. are supported by capacity building activities and advisory missions if needed/requested. In terms of the number of staff, usually 1 or 2 Regional Advisors are engaged in the implementation of projects.

For example:

In the Subprogramme on Statistics, a consultant worked under the supervision of the ECE Regional Advisor on Statistics and the UN Country Team in Moldova to support the development of a new strategy of the national statistical system of Moldova, along with an action plan. As a result of the project, the capacity of the national statistical system to introduce and mainstream innovation in the production of official statistics was enhanced. This will support the implementation of the new national strategy for the development of statistics 2023-2030. In addition, training for National Bureau of Statistics of Moldova, and other relevant government bodies on international recommendations, standards and good practices, related to mainstreaming innovation and the modernization of official statistics was provided.

ECLAC

ECLAC's RPTC Staff is generally comprised of regional advisors and thematic experts, as well as a programme management assistant to support senior staff delivering the technical support requested. As an example of this work, during 2022, subprogramme 10: Statistics, provided support to several Latin American and Caribbean countries on small area estimation techniques, using information from household surveys and integrating information from different statistical sources such as census, administrative records, and satellite images. This technical support involved the work of two thematic experts on statistics (social statistics and geospatial statistics), and two programme management assistants. Other staff from the Statistics Division also collaborated with the provision of this technical support.

ESCWA

The role of ESCWA RPTC staff is to provide advisory services and capacity development to member States. All RPTC staff lead or participate in the execution of RPTC projects. Their expertise is sometimes complemented by that of consultants, the vast majority of which are national, who can stay a longer time in the field to collect data and conduct interviews or perform other longer-term field activities. In-house expertise is also sometimes complemented by consultants when the exact cutting-edge expertise is not available at ESCWA.

For example: In the case of Jordan where ESCWA has worked with the Government to develop a national artificial intelligence strategy and policy over the course of 2 years: this required having extensive national consultations and data gathering (through interviews, focus groups, etc.) It was

essential that ESCWA hired a national consultant while the regional adviser oversaw the work, made sure it included best global and regional practices and lessons learned, and formulated the official policies and strategies based on the data and information collected by the national consultant.

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Q: With regard to the increase of officer training on protection on issues such as double tax treaties (paragraph 23.72 to 23.74) How much is planned for 2020 and 2021, what are the targets?

35.1 The COVID-19 pandemic has made it more urgent than ever to build capacity to fight tax evasion and tax avoidance, including through training on tax treaty-related aspects of tax base protection, in order to expand the fiscal space for countries to invest in immediate crisis needs and recovery efforts, without creating extra pressure on compliant taxpayers. While travel constraints remain in place and holding in-person meetings and workshops not possible (or advisable) due to COVID-19, DESA has prioritized the conversion of existing relevant training in an online accessible format.

35.2 Throughout the second and third quarters of 2020, DESA has been developing an online course on tax dispute avoidance and resolution focusing on mutual agreement procedure (MAP), which builds upon contents of the relevant chapter of the UN Manual on Dispute Avoidance and Resolution. Tax dispute avoidance and resolution mechanisms are critical to facilitate the efficient and equitable determination and collection of tax revenues, which are due and much needed to address the challenges posed by COVID-19. The UN Online Primer on Mutual Agreement Procedure allows the provision of remote basic-level training on tax dispute avoidance and resolution and it will also offer an effective pre-requisite training in preparation for participation in more advanced face-to-face workshops on this matter, as soon as these activities are resumed. This course complements DESA's existing online courses on international tax cooperation, namely the UN Online Primer on Tax Treaties and the UN Online Primer on Transfer Pricing, which are available in English, French and Spanish.

35.3 Since the release of the first batches of modules of the UN Online Primer on Mutual Agreement Procedure in June and July 2020, 56 participants have registered for this course. In addition, 278 participants have registered so far in 2020 to participate in the UN Online Primers on Tax Treaties and on Transfer Pricing in all languages available.

35.4 Moreover, DESA has been developing virtual workshops on selected tax treaty issues for tax officials in the tax administrations and ministries of finance of developing countries. These workshops focus on key aspects of tax treaties, such as their scope of application, the rules on taxation of business profits, employment income, services and passive income, as well as the provisions on exchange of tax information. In the second and third quarters of 2020, 4 virtual workshops have been organized with a regional focus on Latin America, attended by more than 70 participants from 12 countries in the region.

35.5 For the remainder of 2020, DESA is targeting an additional 100 participants in online courses on international tax cooperation, with at least 25 participants registered in each course

(in all the available languages). In addition, DESA is targeting additional 3-4 virtual (or, if possible, in-person) workshops on issues related to tax base protection, including tax treaty and transfer pricing-related issues, with participation of at least 60 tax officials from different regions.

35.6 For 2021, in the area of tax base protection, DESA is planning to hold the following (either virtually or in-person): 1 global workshop, with a target of 30 participants; 3 regional workshops (Africa, Asia and Latin America) with a cumulative target of 100 participants, and; 4 country-level technical cooperation missions with target participation of 10 tax officials for each country.

36 Financial sustainable development, many entities are doing similar work, what part RPTC does?

DESA's capacity-building on international tax cooperation through the RPTC has a unique angle as it draws upon the relevant policy guidance developed by the UN Committee of Experts on International Cooperation in Tax Matters, including the UN Model Double Taxation Convention, the UN Manual on Transfer Pricing, the UN Handbook on Taxation of Extractive Industries and pioneer work on environmental taxation. Since DESA's subprogramme 9 provides secretariat support to the Committee, it is in a special position to leverage the links and dynamic interaction between the policy and capacity-building work in this area and promote an integrated approach to best assist developing countries. Moreover, DESA represents the UN in the Platform for Collaboration on Tax (PCT), a collaborative partnership with the IMF, OECD and World Bank, which aims at sharing information and cooperating on tax capacity building, with a view to leveraging synergies and avoiding any unnecessary duplication of work in this area. In the same vein, DESA collaborates with regional organizations of tax administrations in delivering its capacity-building programmes at the regional and country level.

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Q: Last year there were three recommendations made by the Committee in its report, but the fascicle does not reflect action taken to implement them. Please explain action taken to implement the recommendation. Please provide information on the entity leading on implementing the recommendations and providing consolidated response.

1.1 In its report on the proposed programme budget for 2020 (A/74/7) the Committee made the following comments on the proposed budget for the RPTC. "The Advisory Committee trusts that the implementing entities will ensure the alignment of their activities towards the achievement of the Sustainable Development Goals." (paragraph V.96), "The Advisory Committee trusts that the relevant departments of the Secretariat and the regional commissions will strengthen their outreach to Member States with regard to the services available through the regular programme of technical cooperation." (paragraph V.98), and "The Advisory Committee encourages the implementing entities to continue to leverage cooperation with United Nations and other partners to enhance the impact of their activities" (paragraph V.100). The Secretariat's actions in response to these three key areas highlighted in the Committee's report, though incorporated in the body of

the fascicle, were not included as a separate Annex in the proposed budget report for 2021 (A/75/6 (Sect.23). Actions taken in respect of these three key areas are as follows:

Ensuring alignment of activities to the Sustainable Development Goals

1.2 All the activities under the regular programme of technical cooperation provide support for formulating viable national strategies, policies and programmes that integrate the 2030 Agenda, the Addis Ababa Action Agenda and other relevant policy frameworks, in relation to the achievement of the Sustainable Development Goals and other internationally agreed development goals.

1.3 For example, all the DESA capacity building activities are aligned with the SDGs, their interlinkages, and the overall implementation of the 2030 Agenda as follows: a) strengthening national statistical systems to support the implementation of the 2030 Agenda is the key focus of Subprogramme 4's (Statistics) RPTC activities. Adjusting the activities to reflect the changes and restrictions due to the COVID-19 crises is being undertaken in full support of this key area; b) work planned to support countries with smooth transition strategies for graduation from LDC status aims to help countries integrate these strategies in their national development plans, which is the main national mechanism for advancing the 2030 Agenda within each country; c) supporting development of the Common Country Analysis (CCA) helps the UNRC/UNCT to effectively use and translate global and regional economic outlooks and risks to develop country specific policy guidance. Improved CCAs will lead to a strengthened UN Sustainable Development Framework to support countries to make progress towards SDGs; d) subprogramme 8 (Sustainable forest management) developed and adopted the United Nations Strategic Plan for Forests in 2017 which provides a framework for action aimed at achieving the Global Forest Goals and enhancing the contribution of forests to the achievement of the SDGs. The sub-programme has also been working with partners to develop a global core set of forest related indicators. These indicators, inter alia, aim to improve reporting on the contribution of forests and sustainable forest management to various global policy goals and processes including the SDGs, UNSPF, Biodiversity targets and Paris Agreement. The sub-programme's Global Forest Financing Facilitation Network (GFFFN) is also focused on mobilizing resources for supporting sustainable forest management which also contributes to finance targets under SDG 17; e) subprogramme 9 (Financing for sustainable development) provided capacity-building support to Member States to mobilize financing and other means of implementation for sustainable development, within the framework of the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development and the Addis Ababa Action Agenda on Financing for Development, and; f) subprogramme 5 (Population) continues to be aligned with the SDGs by supporting Member States in the production and use of population estimates and projections, disaggregated by age and sex (SDG 17.18). These data underlie the analysis of linkages between demographic trends and SDG 1 (poverty reduction and fiscal effects on social protection systems), SDG 2 (slower population growth easing demographic pressure in the fight against hunger and contributing to improved nutrition and food security), SDG 3 (connection to improved child and maternal health and healthy lives for all), and with SDG 4 (association between reduced fertility and increased investment in education per child), among others.

Strengthening outreach to Member States regarding the services available through the RPTC

1.4 Given the demand-driven nature of the RPTC, raising awareness of implementing entities offerings for developing countries is not carried out in the form of an outreach campaign as such, but rather through word of mouth and face-to-face meetings with government officials (including Permanent Representatives) from developing countries in the

context of intergovernmental meetings, conferences and departmental workshops. These informal settings are better suited for an initial assessment of country needs and an attempt of matching them with in-house expertise. Further information regarding the outreach activities of all the RPTC entities can be found in Annex E.

Continuing to leverage cooperation with the UN and other partners to enhance the impact of its activities

1.5 Generally, the Resident Coordinators as well as the regional Development Coordination Offices are consulted and engaged in capacity development activities as well as in country-specific advisory missions. For regional activities, sub-programmes work with regional commissions and sub-regional organizations, building on respective comparative advantages.

1.6 For example, DESA Subprogramme 3 (Sustainable Development) in partnership with ESCWA and the League of Arab States (LAS) organized workshops on “VNRs and their follow-up in the Arab Region” in response to feedback from Member States, focusing on multi-stakeholder partnerships for the SDGs. These workshops helped foster regional experience sharing good practices for the implementation of the 2030 Agenda. Similar workshops were held for Caribbean SIDS (with the ECLAC sub-regional office) and Pacific SIDS (with ESCAP). Other examples are regional workshops for stakeholder engagement, which were held back-to-back with the respective regional sustainable development forums organized by the Regional Commissions.

1.7 Sectoral capacity building events are organized in close cooperation with the respective specialized UN entities and inter-agency bodies. Cooperation with the various partners, remains critical to ensure greater outreach to Member States, as well as greater impact and sustainability of the implementing entities capacity development activities.

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Q: Please provide table, by implementing entity, showing all activities for 2020, including information on the location of these activities, the type of projects, as well as the start and end dates.

6.1 For information concerning the activities for 2020 by entity, please refer to the details provided in Annex C.

6.2 The information in the table provided in Annex C includes activities that have been completed, are currently ongoing and those that are proposed to be undertaken by the end of the year. In the case of DESA, it should be noted that for activities that are forecast for the remainder of the year, two scenarios are included as the basis for the forthcoming events: In scenario A, it is expected that the global travel situation allows for in-person workshops to take place in the last quarter of 2020. In scenario B, it is expected that global travel will not have eased up sufficiently to allow for in-person workshops for the remainder of 2020, therefore, while some preparatory parts of workshops can be organized virtually and the development of training materials undertaken by consultants and/or DESA staff, these workshops may have to be restructured as virtual workshops

and if not postponed to 2021. In addition to the activities in Annex C, 26 activities were called off due to the COVID-19 pandemic and 10 have been postponed to 2021; efforts are being made to reformulate the cancelled activities.

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Q: Please provide, during the periods 2010 to 2015, and 2015 to 2030, the magnitude of the RPTC work pre and after 2030 Agenda approval. How many Member States benefit from the RPTC?

Details on the magnitude of resources for the RPTC, can be found in the response to question 10 provided to the Committee on 17 July 2020. As an example of the nature of the support provided to Member states before and after the adoption of the 2023 agenda, details of DESA's activities for that time period can be found in Annex D. 47 On Tables S.23.23 and S.23.24 in SI 1 can we get an explanation of relatively low spending in different entities and under different items of expenditure. Please refer to the table in Annex F for details and explanations for the level of expenditure for each entity by budget class as of 30 June 2020. 48 Is some of this under expenditure in any way related to the impact of COVID-19 and may we expect a similar situation in 2021? Please refer to the response provided for question 47 above. 49 And Is some low spending in any way related to the impact of liquidity difficulties and may we expect a similar situation in 2021? Please refer to the response provided for question 48 above for details relating to the expenditure levels for 2020. Regarding the potential impact for 2021, please refer to the response provided for question 16 to the Committee on 21 July 2020. 53 Which elements of the budget and specific figures contained therein – under this and other sections – are calculated on the assumption that there will be either effective vaccine against COVID-19 or effective treatment of this virus? Please refer to the response provided for question 16 to the Committee on 21 July 2020. 54 Is this fascicle based on needs assessment or not? Is there a gap or mismatch between the needs and resources proposed for 2021? And what is the size of this gap or mismatch? The proposed resources for 2021 for the RPTC reflect an adequate level for effective and efficient implementation of the proposed plans for 2021. 55 How the distribution of activities between different implementing entities is discussed by the member-states, in particular in the framework of the CPC? The Committee for Programme and Coordination does not review the Proposed Programme for the Regular programme on Technical Cooperation (section 23), noting that the RPTC supports the programmes of the implementing entities, which are reviewed by the CPC. The distribution of RPTC activities among the various implementing entities is consistent with the mandates of the respective implementing entity. Each entity interacts with Member States on its capacity development activities and priorities, including the activities funded by RPTC. Annex C: Details of activities for 2020 by entity
Entity Activity Location Type of Start End project date date DESA Contribution of Cooperatives Fiji Capacity 25-Feb- 27-Feb- to Sustainable Development building 20 20 in the South Pacific workshop & Consultancy DESA Building national capacity Uganda Capacity 01-Jan- 31-Dec- for the implementation of the building 20 20 UN Declaration on the workshop Rights of Indigenous Peoples in Uganda DESA Implementation of the White Namibia Capacity 01-Jan- 30-Sep- Paper on Indigenous

Peoples building 20 20 in Namibia. Two workshops. workshop DESA Building National Capacity Kyrgyzstan Capacity May 31-Dec- in Kyrgyzstan on designing building 20 and implementing social workshop & policies (UNCRPD), Phase Consultancy II DESA Building national capacity to Armenia Capacity Q4 Q4 implement UNCRPD in building Central Asia and the workshop Caucuses (virtual and in person) DESA Building Capacities of South Africa and Capacity June Dec Governments to advance three select building SDG implementation African countries workshop through sport for development and peace, Phase I DESA COVID-19 and its impact on Central Asia and Capacity Q4 Q4 older persons in middle- and Europe building low- income countries workshop DESA Learning conference on Beirut Capacity Nov Dec holistic implementation of building the 2030 agenda in the Arab workshop region (virtual and in person) & consultancy DESA Action Today, impact Virtual Capacity 23-Jun-30-Nov- tomorrow: innovation and building 20 20 transforming public services workshop & and institutions to realise the Consultancy SDGs, 2020 UNPSF Workshops DESA Workshop to operationalize South Africa Capacity Nov Dec principles of effective building governance in Africa in workshop Entity Activity Location Type of Start End project date date collaboration with African Peer Review Mechanism DESA Revitalising public service to Kenya Capacity 27-Jul- 31-Jul- speed up achievement of building 20 20 SDGs in Africa workshop DESA Public service innovation South Africa Capacity Q4 Q4 and e-government for SDGs building in Africa workshop DESA Regional workshop for pilot Barbados Capacity 01-Dec- 03-Dec- testing of the toolkit on building 20 20 innovation and public workshop service delivery for sustainable development, CARICAAd DESA Meeting on the Curriculum Virtual Capacity Q4 Q4 on Governance for the SDGs building (would also include the workshop conversion of one toolkit (virtual & in into an online course) person) and consultancy DESA Innovation and digital UNOG Capacity 01-Dec- 31-Dec- transformation building 20 20 workshop (virtual & in person) DESA Capacity Development Virtual (Africa, Capacity April July Webinar Series: Leveraging Latin America, building Public Governance & Pacific SIDS, workshop Exploring Innovative Caribbean SIDS, Solutions to Address the Arab region) COVID-19 Pandemic: Structural challenges, gaps, weaknesses and resilience DESA Developing capacities for Virtual Capacity 24-Jul- 31-Jul- resilience and effectiveness building 20 20 in public sector service workshop delivery amidst a crisis DESA Building Capacity to Access South Africa Capacity Jan 01-Dec- Forest Financing for Malawi Thailand building 20 advancing the Forest related Cote d'Ivoire workshop SDGs & the UNPSPF in four developing countries DESA Building capacity to access Madagascar Capacity Q3 Q3 forest financing in building Madagascar workshop Entity Activity Location Type of Start End project date date DESA Building capacity to access Virtual Capacity Q3 Q3 forest financing in Eastern building Caribbean workshop DESA Building capacity to access Tanzania Capacity 01-Aug- 31-Aug- forest financing in Tanzania building 20 20 workshop DESA Building capacity to access Virtual Capacity 29-Jul- 31-Jul- forest financing in Malawi building 20 20 workshop DESA Building capacity to access Virtual Capacity 24-Aug- 28-Aug- forest financing in Thailand building 20 20 workshop DESA Building capacity to access South Africa Capacity Q3 Q3 forest financing in South building Africa workshop DESA Building capacity to access Cote d'Ivoire Capacity Q3 Q3 forest financing in Cote building d'Ivoire workshop DESA Impact of COVID-19 on Africa (4 Hybrid Q4 Q4 sustainable forest countries) management DESA Capacity Building for Public Uganda Capacity January 30-Apr- Debt Management and building 20 Sustainable Economic workshop Growth in Sub-Saharan Africa DESA Customize macroeconomic Remote - Consultancies 15-Apr- 30-Nov- modelling tools to assess Bangladesh 20 20 economic and social impacts Cambodia, of shocks induced by Georgia, COVID-19 Kazakhstan, Lao PDR, Mongolia, Serbia and Sri Lanka DESA Training on the use of Lao PDR, Capacity 01-Oct- 10-Oct- WEFM-e for SDGs Thailand building 20 20 forecasting workshop DESA Strengthening the CCA Egypt, Jordan,

Capacity 05-May- 31-Dec- analysis of integrated policy Laos, Uganda, building 20 20 issues for achieving the Fiji, Barbados workshops SDGs DESA Application of the Climate, Indonesia, Capacity 01-Jun- 31-Dec- Land, Energy and Water Philippines and building 20 20 systems methodology and Nicaragua workshops (in economy-wide modelling to person & support sustainable virtual) & development in Member Consultancy Entity Activity Location Type of Start End project date date States during the COVID-19 pandemic DESA LDC Graduation Support - Vanuatu (Virtual) Capacity Oct 31-Dec- DESA Pilot building 20 workshop DESA Implementation of the 2030 Lebanon, Egypt Capacity 26-Feb- 27-Feb- Agenda: Follow -up to the building 20 20 Voluntary National Reviews workshop (VNRs) and their follow up in the Western Asia region DESA Capacity building workshop Virtual Capacity 01-Jul- 31-Dec- for conducting sub-national building 20 20 reviews of SDG workshop implementation (virtual and in- person) DESA Capacity Development N/A Consultancies 01-Jul- 31-Dec- programme on water and 20 20 sanitation DESA Workshop on inclusive Ethiopia Capacity Q4 Q4 integration of the 2030 building Agenda, Agenda 2063 and workshop recommendations of the GSDR into national plans and strategies in Africa DESA International MSME UNHQ Capacity Q4 Q4 workshop/Study tour building workshop DESA Water for Sustainable Portugal Capacity Q4 Q4 Development building workshop DESA Capacity building at the 2nd Virtual Capacity 01-Jul- 31-Jul- global conference on building 20 20 strengthening synergies workshop between the Paris Agreement & the 2020 Agenda for sustainable development DESA Capacity Development Tool N/A Consultancies Q3 Q4 Kit DESA Implementation of the 2030 Trinidad Capacity Q4 Q4 Agenda: National webinars building and regional Workshop on workshop Integrated policies and policy coherence for SDGs in selected Caribbean SIDS Entity Activity Location Type of Start End project date date in the context of the novel COVID-19 pandemic DESA Harnessing Climate & SDGs Virtual Capacity Q4 Q4 Synergies to Recover Better building and Stronger from the workshop Covid-19 Pandemic DESA Operationalising the global Jamaica Capacity Q4 Q4 sustainable development building report in the LAC region workshop DESA Accelerating the South Africa Capacity 01-Dec- 31-Dec- Implementation of the 2030 building 20 20 Agenda and AU Agenda workshop 2063 in Africa: Institutions, Policy Coherence and Governance in the time of the COVID-19 Pandemic DESA Supporting National N/A Consultancies Q4 Q4 Partnerships to build back better from COVID-19 DESA Enhance capacity of Sri Lanka Capacity Q4 Q4 stakeholders in Sri Lanka on building designing and implementing workshop effective partnerships for the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) DESA Partnerships for advancing Mexico Capacity Q4 Q4 the Sustainable Development building Goals in Mexico workshop DESA Workshop for Caribbean Trinidad Capacity Oct Nov SIDS on VNRs and building resilience (TBC) workshop DESA Follow-up to the Voluntary Kazakhstan Capacity Oct Dec National Reviews in the building North and Central Asia workshop region DESA Workshop on integrating the Mauritius Capacity Sept Nov 2030 Agenda into national building planning in the AIMS region workshop DESA Implementation of the 2030 Fiji Capacity Sept Nov Agenda: Follow-Up to the building Voluntary National Reviews workshop in the context of the socio- economic impacts of the Entity Activity Location Type of Start End project date date COVID-19 Pandemic in the Pacific Region DESA Enhancing stakeholder Online Capacity July Dec engagement for SDG building implementation and follow workshop up in the times of COVID-19 through development of a Training Manual and an online training DESA From recovery to sustainable Egypt Capacity Nov Dec development: National building webinars and regional workshop Workshop on Integrated recovery policies for the SDGs in selected Northern Africa and Western Asia Region Countries in the context of the novel COVID- 19 pandemic DESA Regional Capacity building Addis Ababa and Capacity Oct Dec workshops for conducting Bangkok (1 building sub-national reviews of SDG workshop in each workshop implementation, accelerating region) progress and using the SDG

framework as a tool for COVID-19 pandemic recovery DESA Capacity building webinars Virtual - 4
 Capacity June Dec on "Sustainable Water and Webinars building Energy Solutions: An workshop
 Integrated Approach for Addressing Critical Services during the COVID-19 World Crisis and Beyond
 DESA Training course on the Virtual - web- Capacity July Dec synergies between the 2030 based
 course building Agenda and Paris Agreement workshop & on climate change to recover Consultancy
 better from Covid-19, in collaboration with UNITAR and UNFCCC DESA Capacity Building on Public
 Namibia Capacity Q4 Q4 Policy Development, building Review, Evaluation and workshop (in
 Coordination for the person & Entity Activity Location Type of Start End project date date Acceleration
 of the SDGs in virtual) and Namibia Consultancies DESA Online tool for long-run N/A Consultancies
 01-Sep- 30-Sep- fiscal and economic 20 20 forecasts based on population projections. DESA
 DESA/ECA Regional Virtual Capacity 07-Dec- 09-Dec- Workshop for Africa on building 20 20 long-run
 economic and fiscal workshop forecasts. DESA DESA International Virtual Capacity 3-4 11-Sep-
 Workshop on implication of building Aug-20 20 population ageing for workshop sustainable
 development. DESA Strengthening national Virtual Capacity Q4 Q4 capacity to incorporate the building
 impact of COVID-19 into workshop population projections DESA Regional thematic Manila, Capacity
 12-Feb- 14-Feb- conference on managing a Philippines building 20 20 statistical organization in
 workshop times of change DESA 2020 Round of Censuses - Congo Capacity 01-Nov- 31-Dec-
 francophone Africa #2, Brazzaville building 20 20 Congo Brazzaville workshop DESA Regional
 Thematic Uzbekistan Capacity 10-Nov- 12-Nov- conference on Managing a building 20 20 statistical
 organization in workshop times of change - SEE- EECCA, Uzbekistan DESA 6th International
 Conference Virtual Capacity 29-Aug- 02-Sep- on the use of Big Data building 20 20 workshop DESA
 Technical training for NSOs Mexico (Virtual) Capacity Q4 Q4 on the implementation of building national
 COVID-19 datahubs workshop DESA ESCAP Economic Statistics Thailand Capacity 22-Jun- 26-Jun-
 seminar on digitalization, (Virtual) building 20 20 Thailand workshop DESA UN LIA Africa, Namibia
 Namibia Capacity 15-Sep- 18-Sep- building 20 20 workshop DESA World Data Forum (pre- Virtual
 Capacity 17-Oct- 21-Oct- event), Switzerland building 20 20 workshop Entity Activity Location Type of
 Start End project date date DESA Developing guidance N/A Consultancy Jan July material to design
 and implement INFFs DESA Strengthening developing Honduras Capacity Q4 Q4 countries' capacity
 to (Virtual) building mobilize domestic resources workshop & and long-term finance for Consultancy
 investment in sustainable development - Honduras DESA Strengthening developing Virtual Capacity
 Q4 Q4 countries' capacity to building mobilize domestic resources workshop and long-term finance for
 investment in sustainable development - Austria DESA Strengthening developing Tanzania Capacity
 Q3 Q3 countries' capacity to building mobilize domestic resources workshop and long-term finance for
 investment in sustainable development - Tanzania DESA Strengthening developing Ethiopia Capacity
 Q4 Q4 countries' capacity to Building mobilize domestic resources workshop and long-term finance for
 investment in sustainable development - Ethiopia DESA Strengthening developing Jamaica Capacity
 Q4 Q4 countries' capacity to Building mobilize domestic resources workshop and long-term finance for
 investment in sustainable development - Jamaica DESA Second Global Workshop for Virtual Capacity
 Feb June the 2020 Voluntary National Building Reviews at the United workshop Nations High-Level
 Political Forum (HLPF) on Sustainable Development and the Regional Preparatory Workshop for ECE
 Region VNR Countries UNCTA eTrade for Women Regional Abidjan, Côte Capacity- 26-Feb- 28-Feb-
 D Masterclass d'Ivoire building 20 20 Entity Activity Location Type of Start End project date date
 UNCTA Stakeholder workshop for Abidjan, Côte Capacity- 02-Mar- 06-Mar- D eTrade Readiness
 d'Ivoire building 20 20 Assessment, Côte d'Ivoire - 100 people attended from government, private
 sector, civil society and international organizations UNCTA Follow up on preparation for Benin, Burkina

Regional ongoing ongoing D the EIF Tier 2 project: Faso, Niger project, "Facilitation of transit, Capacity transport and trade in West building Africa for better participation in value chains" UNCTA Preparation of draft project East Africa and Regional April ongoing D document for TradeMark Africa project, East Africa (TMEA) for a Capacity project on "Assuring Rules building of Origin (RoO) as building blocks of regional value chains in Africa UNCTA Preparation for the annual Florence (Italy) Capacity Expecte 8 D & EUI round table on rules of origin building d 6 October at the European University October 2020 Institute (EUI) to be held from 6 to 8 October 2020 in Italy for LDCs Member States. UNCTA ASEAN LDC project: "A Cambodia, Lao Capacity Feb-19 ongoing D new trade policy and strategy PDR, Myanmar building for ASEAN LDCs" UNCTA The website on the UNCTAD UNCTAD's Jun-20 Until D utilization of trade website today preferences UNCTA EIF actions- Newsletter UNCTAD UNCTAD's Mar-20 Jul-20 D News EIF & EIF Working Group Meeting Geneva - EIF, 23-Apr- 29-May- UNCTA on Switzerland Monitoring and 20 20 D "Management Response to Evaluation the Meta-Evaluation of the EIF" EIF & EIF Board Meeting Geneva - Public Meeting 25-Jun- 25-Jun- UNCTA Switzerland 20 20 D EIF & EIF Steering Committee Geneva - Public Meeting 02-Jul- 02-Jul- UNCTA Switzerland 20 20 D Entity Activity Location Type of Start End project date date WTO & WTO LDCs Group Geneva - Expert Meeting Each Each UNCTA "Developing preferential Switzerland year year D rules of origin (RoO) and the elaboration of proposals on RoO UNCTA 44th regional course Eastern Europe Regional 24-Aug- 04-Sep- D (Skopje, North project 20 20 Macedonia) Capacity building UNCTA 45th regional course Middle East and Regional 01-Dec- 11-Dec- D North Africa project 20 20 (Cairo, Egypt) Capacity building UNCTA Interregional platform Geneva, Regional 28-Sep- 30-Sep- D Switzerland project 20 20 Capacity building UN- Technical cooperation China Technical 2020 2020 Habitat project focusing on the Cooperation localization and Project implementation of NUA and urban SDGs in China (Cities of Nanjing, Changsha, Taiyuan and Suqian) UN- Research on "Global Global/ China Technical 20-Sep- 01-Sep- Habitat Sustainable Award Cooperation 20 22 (Shanghai Award)" in Project context with UN-Habitat flagship programme "SDG cities", in cooperation with Ministry of Housing and Urban-Rural Development of China and Shanghai Municipal Government UN- Technical cooperation to the Ethiopia Technical 2020 2020 Habitat Government of Ethiopia and Cooperation the UN Country team on Project development of durable settlement solutions for IDPs UN- Technical cooperation to the Ethiopia Technical 2020 2020 Habitat Government of Ethiopia on Cooperation managing rapid urbanization Project UN- Technical cooperation to the Somalia Technical 2020 2020 Habitat UN Resident Coordinator Cooperation (Somalia) on durable Project settlements solutions for IDPs Entity Activity Location Type of Start End project date date UN- Technical cooperation Somalia Technical 2020 2020 Habitat (Somalia) on private sector Cooperation investment in housing and Project sustainable urban development UN- Technical cooperation in Colombia Technical 2020 2020 Habitat Colombia on settlement Cooperation solutions for displaced Project populations UN- Technical cooperation Kenya Technical 2020 2020 Habitat project in Kenya to support Cooperation the capacity of councils to Project achieve sustainable urban development UN- Technical cooperation Uganda Technical 2020 2020 Habitat project in Uganda on Cooperation sustainable urban Project development as part of a World Bank joint initiative on the implementation framework for sustainable urban development UN- Technical cooperation Egypt Technical 2020 2020 Habitat project in Egypt on Cooperation sustainable urban Project development as part of a World Bank joint initiative on the implementation framework for sustainable urban development UN- Regional project on Caspian Sea Technical 2020 2020 Habitat sustainable, safe, resilient region Cooperation and inclusive urbanization in (Azerbaijan, Iran) Project the context of climate migration UN- Regional project on Eastern Europe Technical 2020 2020 Habitat monitoring the and Central Asia Cooperation implementation of urban Project SDGs in selected

countries undergoing transition UN- Initiation of selected Eastern Europe Technical 2020 2020 Habitat technical cooperation and Central Asia Cooperation projects on implementation Project of NUA in selected countries undergoing transition UN- Event on urban migration Global Seminars, 01-Feb- 01-Feb- Habitat workshops, 20 20 Entity Activity Location Type of Start End project date date fellowships and training events UN- Event on urban crisis Global Seminars, 01-Feb- 01-Feb- Habitat prevention and recovery workshops, 20 20 fellowships and training events UN- Training seminar on Eastern Europe Seminars, 2020 2020 Habitat localization of urban SDGs and Central Asia workshops, in selected countries fellowships and undergoing transition training events UN- Regional workshop on Eastern Europe Seminars, 2020 2020 Habitat implementation monitoring and Central Asia workshops, of urban SDGs in selected fellowships and countries undergoing training events transition UN- World Urban Forum 10 Global Seminars, 01-Feb- 01-Feb- Habitat workshops, 20 20 fellowships and training events UN- International Forum on Kenya/ China Seminars, 01-May- 01-May- Habitat Healthy Cities co-hosted by workshops, 20 20 UN-Habitat, Urban Planning fellowships and Society of China and training events International Society of City and Regional Planners UN- Online Seminar on Belt and Kenya/ China Seminars, Jul 20 Jul 20 Habitat Road Sustainable Cities: workshops, Building Livable Cities in fellowships and Post-COVID-19 Time co- training events hosted by UN-Habitat, China Centre for Urban Development and ICLEI UN- Shanghai Manual (2020 China Publications 2020 2020 Habitat Annual Report) UN- State of China's Cities China Publications 2020 2021 Habitat Report UN- Global Urban Global Publications 2020 2020 Habitat Competitiveness Report (2019-2020) UN- Cloud Launch of UN-Habitat China Publication Jul 20 Jul 20 Habitat Report: Future Cities Advisory Outlook 2020 - Urban Technology in China UN- Urbanization challenges and Eastern Europe Publications 2020 2021 Habitat opportunities in countries and Central Asia undergoing transition UN- State of Arctic Cities Report Arctic Region Publications 2020 2021 Habitat Entity Activity Location Type of Start End project date date UN- Urban Recovery Framework Global Technical 2020 2021 Habitat Materials UN- Managing migration in cities Global Technical 2020 2021 Habitat Materials UN- Technical Guidance Notes Eastern Europe Technical 2020 2021 Habitat for implementing the New and Central Asia Materials Urban Agenda in Countries undergoing Transition (National Urban Policy, Urban Planning and Design, Municipal Finance, Urban Legislation, Local Implementation) UN- Advisory services to Global Global/ China Other 01-Jan- 01-Oct- Habitat Observance of World Cities substantive 20 20 Day (WCD) deliverables, including advisory services UN- Advisory services to the Global/ China Other 2020 2020 Habitat collaboration between UN- substantive Habitat and South-South deliverables, Cooperation Assistant Fund including advisory services UN- Advisory services to Chinese China Other 01-Jan- 01-Feb- Habitat Delegations participated in substantive 20 20 tenth session of World Urban deliverables, Forum and related activities including advisory services UN- Advisory services and actual China Other 2020 2020 Habitat supports to Chinese substantive Delegations visited HQ of deliverables, UN-Habitat to meet and including discuss variety of advisory cooperation focusing on services implementation of SDGs and NUA UN- Advisory services on Eastern Europe Other 2020 2020 Habitat implementation monitoring and Central Asia substantive of urban SDGs in selected deliverables, cities and countries in including Eastern Europe and Central advisory Asia services UN- Advisory services on Eastern Europe Other 2020 2020 Habitat implementation of NUA in and Central Asia substantive deliverables, Entity Activity Location Type of Start End project date date selected countries including undergoing transition advisory services UN- Advisory services on Global Other 2020 2020 Habitat mainstreaming migration substantive into sustainable urbanization deliverables, in selected countries including advisory services UN- Advisory services on climate Eastern Europe Other 2020 2020 Habitat change and sustainable and Central Asia substantive urbanization in selected

deliverables, countries undergoing including transition advisory services UNODC Development of a National Central African Legislative Q3 Q4 Action Plan against Republic assistance, trafficking in persons policy advice, and capacity building UNODC Legislative assistance and Ghana Legislative Q3 Q3 COVID emergency support assistance and to the prison system capacity building UNODC Countering corruption in Kenya Capacity Q3 Q4 Kenya's medical sector building UNODC Prison sector assessment Myanmar Policy advice Q4 Q4 and capacity building UNODC Justice sector assessment and Sudan Policy advice Q3 Q4 support as basis for sustained and capacity support to Sudan's transition building UNODC Strengthening the criminal Pacific islands Capacity Q3 Q4 justice system, integrity and building the COVID-19 response through support to maritime law enforcement agencies in the Pacific islands region UNODC Strengthening alternatives to Central America Policy advice Q3 Q4 imprisonment in Central and capacity America building UNODC Enhancing understanding Central America Policy advice Q3 Q4 and analysis of transnational and capacity organized crime threats and building the impact on criminal justice systems in the Northern Triangle Entity Activity Location Type of Start End project date date UNODC Strengthening resilience of Central Asia Policy advice Q4 Q4 the penitentiary system and capacity against pandemics building UNODC Assessing and strengthening Paraguay Policy advice Q3 Q4 the criminal justice sector and capacity and responses to building transnational organized crime and drugs in Paraguay UNODC Advisory missions by Inter- depending on Legislative Q3 Q4 regional Advisor travel restrictions assistance, policy advice and capacity building OHCHR Capacity-building for civil Philippines Capacity- Q2 Q4 society/academia/Philippines building NHRI on strategic use of and engagement with human rights mechanisms. OHCHR Technical assistance, Philippines Technical Q2 Q4 expertise and capacity assistance development with the Philippines Commission on Human Rights based on the OHCHR technical cooperation agreement i.e. 1) human rights indicators; 2) human rights investigations (Seminars) OHCHR Training to mediators of the Cambodia Capacity- Q1 Q4 justice service centres on building resettlement cases. OHCHR Training for local-level Mongolia Capacity- Q4 Q4 judges and law enforcement building authorities on incorporating international human rights law and jurisprudence into their reasoning and judgement OHCHR Training for new staff on Mongolia Capacity- Q4 Q4 NPM after adoption of Law building on NHRCM OHCHR Workshop on promotion and Mongolia Advisory Q4 Q4 participation of CSOs in law-services making process OHCHR Monthly meetings of youth Mongolia Advisory Q4 Q4 human rights defenders' services network Entity Activity Location Type of Start End project date date OHCHR Technical cooperation Philippines Capacity- Q4 Q4 project with NHRI on HR building Indicators and HR investigations OHCHR UNCT/CSOs training on the Mongolia Capacity- Q4 Q4 rights of minorities as follow building up to the CERD recommendations. OHCHR Expert meetings on Human Thailand Technical Q1 Q4 Rights and public health assistance approaches in addressing prison overcrowding and over-incarceration by individuals accused of drug offenses and contributing to advance the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development OHCHR Technical advice on Argentina Technical Q1 Q4 legislative initiatives that assistance directly impact the enjoyment of human rights OHCHR Technical advice on Chile Technical Q1 Q4 legislative initiatives that assistance directly impact the enjoyment of human rights OHCHR Raising awareness activities: Argentina Technical Q1 Q4 compliance with human assistance rights standards on Woman and Girls Offenders treatment. Focusing on avoiding pre-trial detention for pregnant women and girls, and mothers who have children under their care. OHCHR Raising awareness activities: Chile Technical Q1 Q4 compliance with human assistance rights standards on Woman and Girls Offenders treatment. Focusing on avoiding pre-trial detention for pregnant women and girls, and mothers who have children under their care. Entity Activity Location Type of Start End project date date OHCHR Raising awareness activities: Paraguay Technical Q1 Q4

compliance with human assistance rights standards on Woman and Girls Offenders treatment. Focusing on avoiding pre-trial detention for pregnant women and girls, and mothers who have children under their care. OHCHR Raising awareness activities: Uruguay Technical Q2 Q4 compliance with human assistance rights standards on Woman and Girls Offenders treatment. Focusing on avoiding pre-trial detention for pregnant women and girls, and mothers who have children under their care. OHCHR Technical assistance for Argentina Technical Q2 Q4 reform of legislation and assistance practice in order to reduce the numbers of women and girls in imprisonment. OHCHR Technical assistance for Chile Technical Q2 Q4 reform of legislation and assistance practice in order to reduce the numbers of women and girls in imprisonment. OHCHR Technical assistance for Paraguay Technical Q2 Q4 reform of legislation and assistance practice in order to reduce the numbers of women and girls in imprisonment. OHCHR Technical assistance for Uruguay Technical Q2 Q4 reform of legislation and assistance practice in order to reduce the numbers of women and girls in imprisonment. OHCHR Advice and training for the Bolivia, Chile, Technical Q2 Q4 active participation of Paraguay assistance indigenous peoples, human rights defenders and CSOs in the promotion and protection of human rights, including through the enhancement of working and dialogue spaces with the governments Entity Activity Location Type of Start End project date date OHCHR Support the establishment of Brazil Advisory Q2 Q4 national networks of CSOs, services particularly women rights defenders. OHCHR Support the establishment of Chile Advisory Q2 Q4 national networks of CSOs services and human rights defenders. OHCHR Conducting a Mapping of Brazil, Chile Technical Q2 Q4 risks and vulnerabilities of assistance women human rights defenders in Brazil considering their intersectionalities by region and thematic area and identification of strategies for their protection OHCHR Promote and conduct Paraguay, Advisory Q2 Q4 national dialogues in the Uruguay services context of the UPR, with the participation of the Government, the NHRI, civil society organizations, indigenous and people of African descent, and the UNCT OHCHR Regional seminar on Brazil Capacity- Q2 Q4 environmental HR building defenders, including indigenous people + Escazú + climate change OHCHR Awareness raising and South America Advisory Q2 Q4 interaction with relevant region services counterparts, for the effective protection of human rights defenders, including reprisals, and follow-up of emblematic cases. OHCHR Supporting the National Argentina Technical Q2 Q4 Supreme Court and assistance provincial supreme courts in adapting the materials for training judges on gender stereotyping and providing technical support on national guidelines/protocols to avoid gender stereotype on the judiciary's ruling. Entity Activity Location Type of Start End project date date OHCHR Promotion of the OHCHR Brazil Capacity Q2 Q4 guidance against racial building profiling among the public security and justice system. OHCHR Small grants to the Chile Capacity Q2 Q4 Intersectoral Round Table of building Persons with Disabilities, specifically, for the design and printing of informative material on COVID-19 in accessible formats. OHCHR Support the elaboration of Peru Capacity Q2 Q4 national policy on human building rights and non- discrimination OHCHR Technical cooperation for Peru Technical Q2 Q4 the elaboration and assistance implementation of the national policy on HR and non discrimination. OHCHR Regional meeting on the South America Advisory Q2 Q

Category: COVID-19 Impact | Source: PPB2021_ACABQ_QA_Section_23_RPTC Set 3 final COMBINED.pdf | Year: 2022
 Path: [https://unitednations.sharepoint.com/sites/DESA-CDPMO/Shared%20Documents/General/3.%20Finance%20Management/2%20-%20REGULAR%20PROGRAMME%20\(RPTC\)/2022/Budget/ACABQ/ACABQ%20binder%20docs/5%20-%20ACABQ%20questions%20%26%20responses%20from%20previous%20sessions/PPB2021/PPB2021_ACABQ_QA_Section_23_RPTC%20Set%203%20final%20COMBINED.pdf](https://unitednations.sharepoint.com/sites/DESA-CDPMO/Shared%20Documents/General/3.%20Finance%20Management/2%20-%20REGULAR%20PROGRAMME%20(RPTC)/2022/Budget/ACABQ/ACABQ%20binder%20docs/5%20-%20ACABQ%20questions%20%26%20responses%20from%20previous%20sessions/PPB2021/PPB2021_ACABQ_QA_Section_23_RPTC%20Set%203%20final%20COMBINED.pdf)

Q: ESCWA In addition to the information provided in the table below, ESCWA engaged the services of a creative writing expert to train ESCWA staff on 'storytelling' techniques as part of strengthening outreach of RPTC.

This included writing in a more accessible and user-friendly language, while focusing on human-centred technical cooperation success stories. ESCWA is also revamping its RPTC page on its website to enhance the visibility of its technical cooperation activities.

Type of Entity	Activity	Location	Start date	End date	project	Facilitating regional consensus on priorities stemming from the Advocacy ESCWA Beijing+25 review during the New York Mar-20 Mar-20 and Outreach Commission on the Status of Women Participation in the high-level regional workshop on promoting ESCWA Marrakech Outreach Feb-20 Feb-20 human rights culture and realizing the SDGs Participation in phase 2 of the ESCWA Jeddah Outreach Feb-20 Feb-20 Aid for Trade initiative Participation in subregional workshop on the Regional ESCWA Accountability Framework of Amman Outreach Feb-20 Feb-20 Action to End Child Marriage in Arab States Participation in the Climate ESCWA Stewardship Working Group Saudi Arabia Outreach Mar-20 Mar-20 meeting of the G20 United Nations Participation in the Observatory Economic ESCWA on Border Crossings Status due Commission for Outreach Mar-20 Ongoing to COVID-19 Europe and other UN entities Dissemination of findings on the mapping of protective and awareness-raising measures ESCWA Regional Outreach Mar-20 Apr-20 accessible to persons with disabilities on COVID-19 and through a webinar United Nations Delivery of seminars on Interregional Crime ESCWA transitional justice from a gender and Justice Research Outreach Apr-20 Apr-20 perspective Institute & University for Peace Participation in a webinar on ESCWA managing broken supply chains UNCT Kuwait Outreach May-20 May-20 during COVID-19 in Kuwait Participation in the national committee for dealing with the ESCWA impacts of COVID-19 on social Tunisia Outreach May-20 Jun-20 protection and access to equitable social services Participation in a regional conference on the impact of ESCWA Regional webinar Outreach Jun-20 Jun-20 COVID-19 on the transport sector in the Arab region Annex I: Expenditure level by entity for 2020, as of 30 June 2020 Expenditure 1 Appropriation January to 30 Implementation Entity Budget Class 2020 June 2020 rate Explanation DESA Other Staff Costs 5,307.7 1,777.0 33.5% The lower level of the expenditure is a result of the uncertainty during the first months of 2020 due to the liquidity crisis. DESA Consultants 688.8 346.0 50.2% Consultants continue to be hired to assist the department in Experts developing training materials as well as background materials for policy discussions and/papers to support Member States DESA Travel of Staff 664.1 111.2 16.7% The low level of expenditure is mainly attributable to the impact of the COVID-19 pandemic which has prevented the organization of most in-person advisory meetings and training workshops owing to the prohibition of large gatherings and the worldwide travel ban DESA Contractual 88.9 101.0 113.6% The higher level of expenditures in the first six months of the Services year is attributable to (a) two individual contractors in areas of Integrated National Financing Framework and electronic document repository design (recommendation by Board of Auditors) who had been budgeted as consultants (b) Small amount of investments in purchasing of software licenses for virtual meetings /training platforms as well as acquiring services to train DESA staff who act as resource persons to more effectively deliver workshops and training virtually DESA General 195.9 27.5 14.0% The low expenditures are mainly attributable to the impact of Operating the COVID-19 pandemic which has delayed the Expenses implementation of in-person workshops and the related general operating expenses. DESA Furniture and - 7.9 - N/A Equipment DESA Grants and 1,637.1 89.0 5.4% The low level of the expenditure is mainly attributable to the Contributions impact of the COVID-19 pandemic which has delayed the implementation of in-person workshops and the travel of
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participants. DESA Total 8,582.5 2,459.7 28.7% Expenditure 1 Appropriation January to 30
 Implementation Entity Budget Class 2020 June 2020 rate Explanation UNCTAD Other Staff Costs
 865.9 364.9 42.1% The implementation rate is slightly below 50% due to uncertainty during the first
 months of 2020 due to the liquidity crisis. UNCTAD will fully utilize the budget by the year-end.
 UNCTAD Consultants - 0.5 - Experts UNCTAD Travel of Staff 236.8 3.8 1.6% These activities have
 been delayed due to COVID-19 and UNCTAD has planned to implement the activities in quarter 3 and
 4 of 2020 UNCTAD Grants and 398.7 (2.1) (0.5%) These activities have been delayed due to
 COVID-19 and Contributions UNCTAD has planned to implement the activities in quarter 3 and 4 of
 2021 UNCTAD Total 1,501.4 367.2 24.5% UN-Habitat Posts - 142.3 - UN-Habitat Other Staff Costs
 841.6 343.0 40.8% The implementation rate is slightly below 50% due to uncertainty during the first
 months of 2020 due to the liquidity crisis. UN-Habitat expects to fully implement the budget by the end
 of the year UN-Habitat Consultants 3.1 - 0.0% These activities have been delayed due to COVID-19
 and Experts depending on the development of the pandemic, the budget is expected to be repurposed
 for additional technical advisory services to countries that Inter-regional Advisors cannot travel to due
 to travel limitations. UN-Habitat Travel of Staff 74.3 11.8 15.9% Limited advisory missions might be
 conducted in 2021. From mid-March 2020, all travels were discontinued until further notice (lifting of
 global travel restrictions due to Covid-19 induced situation); a re-purposing of part of the budget is
 suggested for 2021. Part of the "travel on official business" budget is to be repurposed, potentially for
 additional technical advisory services by in-country experts. Expenditure 1 Appropriation January to 30
 Implementation Entity Budget Class 2020 June 2020 rate Explanation UN-Habitat Contractual 108.6
 1.0 0.9% Language training for Inter-regional Advisors will continue, Services with online services
 being extended. The total budget for this category is envisaged to 2 terms per Inter-regional Advisor in
 the remaining period of time. Translation services will be needed as soon as project activities will pick
 up again, following the Covid-19 induced slow down. Publications will be produced as soon as project
 activities will pick up again, following the Covid-19 induced slow down. Online trainings and webinars
 will continue to be held during this period in time and will continue to be organized in 2021. Online
 trainings for Inter-regional Advisors and focal points of Regional Offices and/ or Programme
 Development Branch. UN-Habitat General 16.5 1.6 9.5% Operating Expenses UN-Habitat Supplies
 and 2.6 - 0.0% Once home-office arrangements have been terminated and staff Materials members
 can return to the office, the UNON will provide the procurement of supply and materials on a cost
 recovery basis. UN-Habitat Furniture and 1.2 - 0.0% Part of the "travel on official business" budget has
 been Equipment repurposed for purchase of IT equipment. UN-Habitat Grants and - 0.6 - Contributions
 UN-Habitat Total 1,047.9 500.4 47.8% UNODC Other Staff Costs 631.4 177.4 28.1% Reflects a delay
 of activities due to COVID-19 impact as well as uncertainty during the first months of 2020 due to the
 liquidity crisis. UNODC Consultants 27.6 - 0.0% The lower rate of implementation is related to a delay
 of Experts activities due to COVID-19 impact UNODC Travel of Staff 84.2 0.9 1.1% The lower rate of
 implementation is related to a delay of activities due to COVID-19 impact UNODC General 3.6 1.0
 28.0% The lower rate of implementation is related to a delay of Operating activities due to COVID-19
 impact Expenses Expenditure 1 Appropriation January to 30 Implementation Entity Budget Class 2020
 June 2020 rate Explanation UNODC Grants and 212.8 1.1 0.5% The lower rate of implementation is
 related to a delay of Contributions activities due to COVID-19 impact UNODC Other Costs - (0.0) -
 UNODC Total 959.6 180.4 18.8% OHCHR Posts - - - OHCHR Other Staff Costs 1,030.7 380.3 36.9%
 The low implementation rate is due to cancellation and OHCHR Consultants 15.2 - 0.0% postponement
 of some activities including travel of staff, Experts experts and participants to technical cooperation
 activities due to restrictions on travel and movement (confinement) by OHCHR Travel of Staff 125.0

19.7 15.7% Governments around the world in light of COVID-19. If similar OHCHR Contractual 37.9 2.0 5.3% restrictions continue, then it is expected that innovative Services methodologies will be employed to implement activities in OHCHR General 111.8 69.8 62.5% 2021 including procurement of IT equipment and software to Operating facilitate virtual meetings and capacity building and technical Expenses assistance, increased use of consultancies and small grants to OHCHR Grants and 945.2 151.1 16.0% CSOs and NHRIs. Contributions OHCHR Total 2,265.8 622.9 27.5% OCHA Other Staff Costs 417.1 199.7 47.9% OCHA Consultants 54.6 - 0.0% The lower rate of implementation is related to delayed activities Experts due to COVID-19. These funds will be expended during the second half of the year as the Policy Forum is held in December. OCHA Travel of Staff 69.3 - 0.0% The lower rate of implementation is related to delayed activities due to COVID-19. These funds will be expended during the second half of the year as the Policy Forum is held in December. And consultations for the forum is undertaken during the third quarter of the year and travel for the forum is undertaken in December. OCHA Contractual 49.9 3.0 5.9% The lower rate of implementation is related to delayed activities Services due to COVID-19. This will be expended in December for the Policy Forum. Expenditure 1 Appropriation January to 30 Implementation Entity Budget Class 2020 June 2020 rate Explanation OCHA General 3.7 0.2 6.2% The lower rate of implementation is related to delayed activities Operating due to COVID-19. This will be expended in December for the Expenses Policy Forum. OCHA Grants and 85.9 0.1 0.1% The lower rate of implementation is related to delayed activities Contributions due to COVID-19. Grants will be expended in the last quarter related to the Policy Forum. OCHA Total 680.5 203.0 29.8% ECA Other Staff Costs 2,798.7 767.3 27.4% The low implementation level is due to the low number of requests received from member states in the first quarter of 2020 and the impact of the COVID-19 pandemic. ECA plans to ECA Consultants 1,654.8 365.6 22.1% utilise the full budget for 2020, in order to respond to the Experts increased number of requests for support from Member States to evaluate the impact of COVID on their economies. Other ECA Travel of Staff 489.4 133.0 27.2% requests for ECA's intervention have also been received; these include areas related to ACFTA, jobs creation, economic ECA Contractual 281.9 18.9 6.7% governance and transformation, inclusive development, Services infrastructure, energy and services, promoting innovative financing for developing capital markets, attracting investment ECA General - 6.0 - and improving the business-enabling environment, data and Operating statistics, climate change, environment and natural resource Expenses management, Poverty, inequality and social policy, Gender and ECA Grants and 2,298.9 17.8% women in development. Contributions 409.3 ECA Total 7,523.7 1,700.0 22.6% ESCAP Other Staff Costs 707.5 14.3% The low implementation level is due uncertainty during the first 101.0 months of 2020 due to the liquidity crisis. Only one Regional Advisor is on board as of June 2020. The recruitment of another Regional Advisor is in progress. ESCAP Consultants 653.9 67.1% The higher implementation rate reflects the reprioritising of Experts 439.1 funds from the initial allocation being allocated to consultant budget class. ESCAP Travel of Staff 407.5 4.6% Due to the travel restrictions owing to COVID-19, limited 18.7 funds are allocated for travel (mostly planned as of now for Q4 2020). Expenditure 1 Appropriation January to 30 Implementation Entity Budget Class 2020 June 2020 rate Explanation ESCAP Contractual 50.9 105.3% Owing to the ongoing COVID-19 related travel restrictions, Services 53.6 demands for contractual services have increased (note however that the corresponding actual planned amount is limited). For example, translation services (ahead of virtual workshops), editing costs, interpretation, printing, etc. ESCAP General 218.3 1.4% Since the organization of a number of workshops/trainings have Operating 3.0 been postponed to Q4 of 2020, related charges have not yet Expenses been incurred. ESCAP Grants and 1,451.7 0.7% Given the travel restrictions due to COVID-19, the organization Contributions 10.1 of limited number of

workshops/trainings are postponed to Q4 of 2020. ESCAP Total 3,489.8 625.5 17.9% ECE Other Staff Costs 1,385.6 40.1% Expenditures under this class reflect the salaries of the Regional 555.2 Advisers. The implementation rate is not linear, as education grants are disbursed in Q.3, full spending is expected by year- end. ECE Consultants 69.3 47.0% The level of implementation is in line with the budget. Experts 32.6 ECE Travel of Staff 192.4 6.5% The low expenditure under this class reflect the trips cancelled 12.5 during the first semester because of the COVID-19 pandemic and substituted by webinars modality. During the second semester, ECE will redeploy part of this budget line towards demand driven activities in response to the COVID-19 pandemic. ECE General - Operating 0.0 Expenses ECE Grants and 525.3 4.3% The underexpenditure under this line is primarily attributable to Contributions 22.9 the planned events (workshops, capacity building trainings) being largely replaced by webinar modalities during the first part of the year due to the COVID-19 pandemic. During the second semester, ECE will redeploy part of this budget line towards demand driven activities in response to the COVID-19 pandemic. ECE Total 2,172.6 623.2 28.7% Expenditure 1 Appropriation January to 30 Implementation Entity Budget Class 2020 June 2020 rate Explanation ECLAC Other Staff Costs 2,300.0 47.7% The implementation rate is in line with projections. 1,096.3 ECLAC Consultants 614.7 48.7% The implementation of resources during the year does not Experts 299.4 follow a linear projection. In addition, the impact of the pandemic in the LAC region, which started in the first quarter of 2020, affected the provision of technical assistance during the most pressing months of the pandemic. Notwithstanding, and in the context of the recovery from the pandemic, ECLAC has been increasing the provision of advisory services, upon request, and has changed and adapted the modalities of deliverance. in this context, it is foreseen that there will be an acceleration in the pace of expenditures in consultancy services in the second semester of the year. ECLAC Travel of Staff 492.4 11.9% Expenditure for travel of staff has been affected due to the 58.5 impact of the pandemic in LAC countries. However, flexibility has been applied and these resources are being allocated to support technical assistance to support technical assistance requested by MS to address the socioeconomic impact of COVID-19. ECLAC Grants and 508.7 10.0 2.0% Expenditure with meeting participants has been affected due to Contributions the impact of the pandemic in LAC countries. However, flexibility has been applied and these resources are being allocated to support technical assistance requested by MS to address the socioeconomic impact of COVID-19. ECLAC Total 3,915.8 1,464.2 37.4% ESCWA Posts - 0.4 ESCWA Other Staff Costs 2,165.4 1,092.0 50.4% ESCWA Consultants 232.7 72.0 30.9% The low level of monthly expenditures in 2020 under Experts consultants, experts and travel of staff is mainly attributed to Expenditure 1 Appropriation January to 30 Implementation Entity Budget Class 2020 June 2020 rate Explanation ESCWA Travel of Staff 304.1 31.2 10.3% the impact of the COVID-19 pandemic on planned activities and travel, including the resulting worldwide ban on travel. During the first months of 2020, particularly as the effects of the epidemic made an initial global adverse impact and ESCWA Contractual 24.0 15.2 63.1% continued to prevent the implementation of planned activities of Services the Commission, its member States, and many other stakeholders, ESCWA was operating by mainly relying on in- ESCWA Grants and 711.8 1.7 0.2% house capacity to the extent possible, and by increasingly Contributions conducting virtual consultations, meetings and all other interactions. ESCWA Total 3,438.0 1,212.4 35.3% RPTC Grand total 35,577.6 9,958.7 28.0%

